national education were attempted even if they failed to wean away *bhadralok* youths from a western education.

In comparison, the gains of the Swadeshi movement in Tamilnadu were patchy. For instance, the National Fund and Industrial Association, despite the best efforts of its promoters, could barely collect Rs 6,000. Even that money was lost when the Arbuthnot and Company, in which it was invested, collapsed.[8]

A celebrated British journalist visiting Madras City in mid-1907 observed, 'And now in Madras I found the Swadeshi movement very strong. "None but Swadeshi goods", "Buy our Nationalist cottons", "Try our Bande Mataram cigarettes", were the most telling advertisements a shop could write up or insert in the native newspapers, which are particularly strong and excellent in Madras.'[9] Henry Nevinson no doubt captures the mood of the people but sadly this spirit did not translate into actual production. As for the idea of indigenous production, it was limited to making glass, soap, candles and matchboxes—hardly anything that would have made the governor of Madras lose his sleep. The registrar of joint stock companies also remarked on this spirit when he noted 'the advent of a new spirit' of enterprise.[10] 'Many of the newly formed trading companies,' he added, 'appear to be intended to encourage Indian manufactures and industries and sale of Swadeshi goods.'[11]

But these efforts were scattered. Cashing in on the patriotism of the consumers was one thing, practising Swadeshi industry was entirely another, more challenging, task. If a rigid test of patriotism was to be applied, few attempts at indigenous enterprise would have qualified for the Swadeshi tag. A case in point would be the Indian Bank which survives to this day.[12] Promoted by the moderate Congress leader V. Krishnaswamy Aiyar and some of his avowedly non-political friends in response to the collapse of the British firm Arbuthnot and Company that ruined thousands of depositors, the Indian Bank was indeed a success but it hardly wore patriotism on its sleeve. At the end of the day, the movement in the Tamil